

SL STUDIO - TRACK PREP CHECKLIST

One page before you hit send. Rule zero: whatever you have right now is already good enough to send.

FORMAT

- ☐ WAV or AIFF, 24-bit (16-bit ok, 32-bit float ok)
- ☐ Same sample rate as the project: 44.1 kHz stays 44.1, 48 stays 48
- ☐ Never convert mp3 to WAV - if mp3 is all you have, send the original mp3
- ☐ Export full length: the last reverb tail rings out completely

LIMITER & HEADROOM

- ☐ No limiter, maximizer or clipper on the master bus
- ☐ Peaks around -6 to -3 dB; no normalizing, no gaining up
- ☐ Quieter than Spotify = you did it right

STEMS (IF YOU CAN EXPORT THEM)

- ☐ Every stem starts at bar 1 (0:00) and has the same length
- ☐ Master bus stays empty while printing stems
- ☐ 6-12 stems: kick, snare, drums, bass, guitars, keys, lead vox, BVs, FX
- ☐ Sanity check: stems in an empty project must sound like your mix

NAMING

- ☐ Folder: Artist_Song_120bpm_Am (tempo and key included)
- ☐ Stems numbered: 01_Kick, 02_Snare, 03_Drums_Rest...
- ☐ One song = one zip

SENDING

- ☐ WeTransfer or Google Drive link - test it in an incognito window
- ☐ Write: what you need, 1-2 reference tracks, what bothers you, deadline

Only a phone recording? Send it as is. Seriously.

Original file, not a messenger voice forward. No enhancement apps, no EQ - I'll take it from there.

Suno / AI track? Send the best-quality export + lyrics (+ stems if the platform gives them).